



WILLIAMSON COUNTY · CENTRAL TEXAS

The Honest Georgetown Relocation Guide

What your tax bill will actually be, which neighborhoods carry a hidden second tax, why a Georgetown address does not mean Georgetown schools, and how long the drive really takes.

Start here

Most relocation guides are brochures. This one is built to talk you out of the wrong house. Every number in it comes from a primary source — the Williamson County tax roll, the school district, the city budget — and every source is linked so you can check it yourself.

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How to use this guide

AND WHY IT LEADS WITH THE BAD NEWS

Georgetown has been the fastest-growing city in the United States among cities over 50,000 people, and it held that title in consecutive years. In one of those years the city grew 10.5% — a pace that would double the population in under 7 years.

That growth^{1,2} is the reason this guide exists. When a town adds thousands of people a year, it builds new subdivisions on the edges — and to pay for the water lines, roads and drainage in those subdivisions, it creates special taxing districts. Two houses that look identical, priced identically, three miles apart, can carry annual tax bills that differ by more than \$4,000.

Nobody hands you that on a listing sheet. That is the single most expensive thing a buyer moving here does not know, so it gets the most space in this guide.

Three rules for reading this

- 1. Verify per address, not per neighborhood.** District boundaries and school zones cut through subdivisions. In one Georgetown community, the school district depends on which builder built the house. Always confirm the specific address.
- 2. Rates change every year.** Every figure here is labeled with its source and period. Taxing entities adopt new rates each fall. Treat these as the shape of the math, then pull current numbers for your address.
- 3. Where sources disagreed, this guide says so** rather than picking the prettier number. Several figures below are flagged as unresolved. That is deliberate.

A note on who wrote this: I am a licensed Texas Realtor and I live in Georgetown. I have an obvious interest in you moving here. That is exactly why this guide is built out of documents you can verify independently instead of my opinions. Where I do give an opinion, it is labeled as one.

1. U.S. Census Bureau, "Fastest-Growing Cities Are Still in the West and South,"
<https://www.census.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2022/fastest-growing-cities-population-estimates.html>

2. U.S. Census Bureau, "Large Southern Cities Lead Nation in Population Growth,"
<https://www.census.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2023/subcounty-metro-micro-estimates.html>

What you actually pay

PART ONE • THE TAX BILL

You will read that Georgetown has low property taxes. That is true of the city's own rate and misleading about your bill.

The city did cut its rate to 35.3 cents per \$100 of valuation, the lowest city rate of any Austin-metro city over 20,000 people.¹ But the city is only one of four entities that taxes your house. Here is the whole stack, from the county's own 2025 tax roll.²

Taxing entity	Rate per \$100	Share of your bill
Georgetown ISD (schools)	1.050600	58%
Williamson County	0.369447	20%
City of Georgetown	0.353000	19%
Williamson County Farm-to-Market / Road	0.044329	2%
Combined rate, inside city limits	1.817376	1.82%

So the honest headline rate is **1.82%**, not 0.35%. On a \$450,000 house with no exemptions, that is \$8,178 a year — about \$682 a month before your mortgage, insurance or a single utility bill.

If the house is outside city limits

You drop the city's 0.353 but pick up **Williamson County ESD #8** at 0.091200 per \$100, which funds fire and emergency response where the city does not.³ Net combined rate lands near **1.5555%**. Lower — but you also lose city services, and city-owned utilities.

1. City of Georgetown FY2026 adopted budget and tax rate, <https://www.hellogeorgetown.com/city-of-georgetown-news/georgetown-city-council-adopts-1-3-billion-fy-2026-budget-lowers-property-tax-rate-but-increases-utility-rates/>

2. Williamson County, "2025 Tax Rates and Exemptions by Jurisdictions" (official tax roll), <https://www.wilcotx.gov/DocumentCenter/View/17027/2025-Tax-Rates-and-Exemptions-1?bidId=>

3. Williamson County ESD #8 rate 0.091200 per the county tax roll (see note 2); district funding detail at <https://www.wilcoesd8.org/budget-and-funding>

The exemption gap

PART ONE • THE MISTAKE THAT COSTS THE MOST

Texas gives you a residence homestead exemption that knocks \$140,000 off your taxable value for school taxes^{1,2} — and school taxes are 58% of your bill. The city, county and road district each take a further slice off. It is the largest single lever on your tax bill, and it is not automatic.

You have to file for it. If you buy and do not file, or if you assume it carried over from the seller, you pay the unexempted rate. Here is the same \$450,000 Georgetown house, inside city limits, no MUD or PID, both ways.

Entity	Taxable value	Exemption applied	Tax
Georgetown ISD	\$310,000	\$140,000 off	\$3,257
Williamson County	\$427,500	greater of \$5,000 or 5%	\$1,579
City of Georgetown	\$427,500	greater of \$5,000 or 5%	\$1,509
Wilco Farm-to-Market / Road	\$447,000	\$3,000 off	\$198
With homestead filed			\$6,543
Without it	\$450,000	none	\$8,178

Filing the exemption is worth about \$1,635 a year

That is \$136 a month, for one form, once. Exemption amounts come from the Williamson County tax roll and the Texas Comptroller; the arithmetic is ours and you should redo it with your own numbers.³

File Form 50-114 with the Williamson County Appraisal District. You can file once you own and occupy the home as your principal residence. Late filing is allowed within 2 years of the deadline, so if you already missed it, you can likely still recover it. Over-65 adds \$60,000 more off school value, and Williamson County adds a \$125,000 over-65 exemption with a ceiling freeze.

1. Texas Comptroller, Property Tax Exemptions — Tax Code §11.13(b), <https://comptroller.texas.gov/taxes/property-tax/exemptions/>

2. Texas Proposition 13 (approved November 2025) raised the school homestead exemption to \$140,000, <https://www.propertytaxes.law/texas-proposition-13-explained/>

3. Exemption amounts per the Williamson County 2025 tax roll (note 2 on page 3); Form 50-114 and the 2-year late-filing window per <https://www.countrytaxcalc.com/tax-guides/usa/property-tax-texas-homestead-2026/>

How the bill scales

PART ONE • THE NUMBERS AT YOUR PRICE POINT

Four price points, inside city limits, with no MUD or PID. Find the row closest to your budget and treat it as the floor, because the next two sections add to it.

Home value	With homestead	Per month	Without homestead	Effective rate
\$398,600	\$5,628	\$469	\$7,244	1.41%
\$450,000	\$6,543	\$545	\$8,178	1.45%
\$550,000	\$8,325	\$694	\$9,996	1.51%
\$700,000	\$10,997	\$916	\$12,722	1.57%

Inside city limits, no MUD or PID, homestead applied as shown on the previous page. The effective rate climbs with price because the \$140,000 school exemption is a fixed dollar amount — it shields proportionally less of an expensive house.

Other exemptions worth asking about

Exemption	What it takes off	Where it applies
Over-65 or disabled	\$60,000 additional off school value, plus a \$3,000 local Georgetown ISD amount	Georgetown ISD
Over-65	\$125,000 off county value, with a tax ceiling that freezes the county portion	Williamson County
Over-65	\$12,000 off city value	City of Georgetown
Disabled veteran	Amount scales with the VA disability rating; a 100% rating can exempt the residence homestead entirely	All entities

Amounts are from the county's published exemption schedule.¹ If you are 65 or older, the county ceiling is the important one — it caps that portion of your bill at the year you qualify, which matters a great deal in a market where appraisals have been climbing. Confirm your own eligibility with the appraisal district rather than relying on this table.

1. Exemption amounts per the Williamson County 2025 Tax Rates and Exemptions schedule, <https://www.wilcotx.gov/DocumentCenter/View/17027/2025-Tax-Rates-and-Exemptions-1?bidId=>

MUDs and PIDs

PART TWO • THE HIDDEN SECOND TAX

This is the section to read twice. It is the difference between the tax bill you expect and the one that arrives.

What they are, in plain English

When a developer builds a subdivision on raw land at the edge of town, somebody has to pay for the water lines, sewer, drainage and roads. Rather than the city funding it, Texas lets the developer create a **Municipal Utility District** — a MUD — which issues bonds to build the infrastructure and then levies its own property tax on the homes inside it to repay those bonds.

A **Public Improvement District**, or PID, does something similar through an assessment rather than a tax. The practical difference matters: a PID assessment is generally not an ad valorem tax, so your homestead exemption does not reduce it.

A **road district** is a third variant, funding road bonds as its own tax line.¹

Why nobody warns you

A MUD is not a scam and it is not hidden in any legal sense — Texas requires seller disclosure. But it does not appear in the listing price, it does not appear in most online tax estimates, and a lender's initial estimate will often miss it. Buyers routinely discover it at closing, or in the first tax bill. New master-planned communities are the most likely to carry one, which means the newest, most attractively marketed neighborhoods are the ones where this hits hardest.

The good news, eventually

MUD taxes are meant to decline as the bonds are repaid and the district's tax base fills in.² Wolf Ranch's own HOA describes its MUD as a 25-year tax.³ So a MUD is a cost with an end date — but it is a long one, and in at least one Georgetown district the debt portion has been rising, not falling. Ask for the district's actual rate history rather than assuming it drops.

1. Williamson County, Public Improvement Districts, <https://www.wilcotx.gov/756/Public-Improvement-Districts-PIDs>

2. Community Impact, "Municipal utility district taxes remain higher than city rates," <https://communityimpact.com/austin/georgetown/city-county/2019/10/15/municipal-utility-district-taxes-remain-higher-than-city-rates-officials-say/>

3. Wolf Ranch HOA, FAQs, <https://www.wolfranchhoa.org/faqs>

A \$4,140 swing on the same house

PART TWO • THE NUMBER THAT MATTERS

Below is one identical \$450,000 home, with the homestead exemption filed, moved from neighborhood to neighborhood. Nothing changes except which special district the lot sits in.

Where the house sits	Extra rate	Total tax	Per month
No MUD or PID — Sun City, Old Town, Berry Creek (original), Highland Village	—	\$6,543	\$545
Georgetown Village — PID No. 1	0.1200	\$7,083	\$590
Somerset Hills — road district	0.2900	\$7,848	\$654
Berry Creek Highlands — MUD	0.5500	\$9,018	\$752
Wolf Ranch — MUD No. 28	0.5775	\$9,142	\$762
Wolf Ranch — MUD No. 29	0.6500	\$9,468	\$789
Rancho Sienna — Wilco MUD No. 12	0.7296	\$9,827	\$819
Water Oak — Wilco MUD No. 25	0.9200	\$10,683	\$890
Parkside on the River — MUD No. 1, 2 or 3	0.9200	\$10,683	\$890

Rates are the county's; the totals are our arithmetic.¹ Parkside's own builder documentation publishes a combined all-in rate above 2.47%.²

What that gap actually costs you

The spread between the cheapest and most expensive district here is **\$4,140 a year — \$345 a month** on the same house at the same price.

Turn that around and it is a borrowing-power problem, not just a budget problem. At 6.5% on a 30-year loan, \$345 a month of payment supports roughly **\$54,600 of mortgage**. A buyer who shops a MUD neighborhood and a non-MUD neighborhood at the same list price is not comparing like for like — they are quietly choosing between two houses about \$55,000 apart in what they can afford.

This is the one calculation to run before you fall in love with a floor plan.

1. District rates from the Williamson County 2025 tax roll, <https://www.wilcotx.gov/DocumentCenter/View/17027/2025-Tax-Rates-and-Exemptions-1?bidId=>; totals are our arithmetic on a \$450,000 value with homestead applied to the four base entities and no exemption assumed against the district levy.

2. Parkside on the River community information sheet (December 2025) publishes a combined all-in rate of 2.471216 per \$100, <https://www.taylormorrison.com/-/media/sites/tm/homes/texas/austin/community-information-sheets/2025/parkside-on-the-river-community-information-sheet--1225.pdf>

Which neighborhoods carry one

PART TWO • VERIFIED FROM THE COUNTY ROLL

Neighborhood	District	2025 rate	Status
Wolf Ranch	Georgetown / Wilco MUD No. 28 and No. 29 — which one depends on the section	0.5775 / 0.6500	Verified
Water Oak at San Gabriel	Wilco MUD No. 25 — debt portion rose 0.60 to 0.65 to 0.75 across 2023-2025	0.9200	Verified
Parkside on the River	Parkside MUD No. 1, No. 2, No. 3	0.9200 each	Verified
Rancho Sienna	Wilco MUD No. 12	0.7296	Verified
Berry Creek Highlands	Berry Creek Highland MUD — new section only, not original Berry Creek	0.5500	Verified
Georgetown Village	Georgetown Village PID No. 1 — assessment, no MUD	0.1200	Verified
Somerset Hills	Somerset Hills Road District	0.2900	Verified
Cimarron Hills	Cimarron Hills PID — annual amount set yearly in the service plan	not published	Amount unverified
Bluffview	Bluffview PID, created 2022	not published	Amount unverified
Heirloom	Heirloom PID, created August 2025	not published	Amount unverified
Teravista	Wilco MUD No. 10 meets inside the neighborhood, but two sources say most sections carry no active MUD tax	0.3875	Disputed

Rates from the county tax roll¹ and the city's audited financial report.² Teravista's status is genuinely unresolved across sources.³

1. Williamson County 2025 Tax Rates and Exemptions, <https://www.wilcotx.gov/DocumentCenter/View/17027/2025-Tax-Rates-and-Exemptions-1?bidId=>

2. City of Georgetown FY25 annual comprehensive financial report, <https://records.georgetowntexas.gov/WebLink/DocView.aspx?id=723431&dbid=0&repo=Georgetown>

3. Teravista MUD status per <https://districtdirectory.org/williamson-county/williamson-county-municipal-utility-district-no-10/> against contrary readings compiled at <https://jbgoodwin.com/blog/georgetownns-property-tax-line-depends-on-the-year-a-mud-was-approved-not-just-the-neighborhood>

Where there is no district, and how to prove it

PART TWO • VERIFYING AN ADDRESS

Two things are worth separating: neighborhoods where the public record clearly shows no special district, and neighborhoods where it simply does not say. The second group is not the same as the first.

Verified clean of both

Sun City Texas, Berry Creek original sections, Old Town / the Historic District, and Highland Village carry no MUD and no PID.

Not confirmed either way — treat as unknown until you check the address: Serenada, La Conterra, Somerset Hills' MUD/PID status separate from its road district, and Crescent Bluff. Absence of evidence is not evidence of absence.

How to check any address yourself, in about 3 minutes

Look the property up on the Williamson County tax records site and read the list of taxing jurisdictions on the bill itself. Every district that taxes that parcel appears as its own line. That document overrides any listing sheet, builder flyer or blog — including this one.

Williamson County property tax search: wilcotx.gov — Tax Assessor-Collector

Five questions to ask before you write the offer

- Which taxing districts appear on this parcel's tax bill, and at what rates?
- If there is a MUD, what has its rate been each year for the last 5 years?
- How much bond debt has the district issued, and how much remains authorized but unissued? Unissued authorization is future tax capacity.
- If there is a PID, what is the annual assessment, and is there an option to pay it off in a lump sum?
- Is the district's rate expected to change at the next adoption?

Ask the listing agent in writing and ask the district directly. If a seller cannot answer question one, that is information too.

A Georgetown address is not a Georgetown ISD address

PART THREE • SCHOOLS

Georgetown is served by several school districts. Buyers assume the mailing address settles it. It does not, and this is the most emotionally expensive mistake in the guide — you can unwind a tax surprise with money, but not a school year.

Neighborhood	Actual district	Detail
Rancho Sienna	Liberty Hill ISD — entire community	Rancho Sienna Elementary is a Liberty Hill ISD campus with a Georgetown mailing address. Feeds Santa Rita Middle, then Legacy Ranch High
Parkside on the River	Split: Georgetown ISD and Leander ISD, by builder	Perry and Taylor Morrison homes feed Georgetown ISD. Coventry, Highland and M/I feed Leander ISD — Parkside Elementary, Stiles Middle, Rouse High
Cimarron Hills	Split: Georgetown ISD and Liberty Hill ISD	Liberty Hill side runs Rancho Sienna Elementary to Santa Rita Middle to Legacy Ranch High. Georgetown side runs San Gabriel Elementary to Tippit Middle to East View High
Teravista	Split: Round Rock ISD and Georgetown ISD	Teravista Elementary on-site is Round Rock ISD; Carver Elementary is Georgetown ISD. Both sit inside the neighborhood
Berry Creek Highlands, Hidden Oaks	Jarrell ISD	Original Berry Creek is Georgetown ISD. The newer Highlands section is Jarrell ISD, which built a \$48,000,000 Berry Creek Elementary inside the subdivision
Southwest corner of the city	Leander ISD	Generally Tarvin or Parkside Elementary, then Stiles Middle and Rouse High

Sources: NCES¹, the Parkside community's own school page², Jarrell ISD³, and the Teravista community association.⁴

1. Rancho Sienna Elementary district affiliation, National Center for Education Statistics, https://nces.ed.gov/ccd/schoolsearch/school_detail.asp?ID=482742013570

2. Parkside on the River, "Our Schools" — builder-by-builder district assignment, <https://parksideontheriver.com/our-schools/>

3. Jarrell ISD, Berry Creek Elementary bond page, <https://www.jarrellisd.org/about-us/about-us/2023-bond/berry-creek-elementary-school>

4. Teravista Community Association, <https://teravistatogether.com/about-us/>

Two school traps worth naming

PART THREE • SCHOOLS

1. In Parkside on the River, the builder determines the school district

This is not a boundary running along a road. Within the same community, homes built by Perry Homes and Taylor Morrison feed **Georgetown ISD**, while homes built by Coventry, Highland and M/I feed **Leander ISD** — Parkside Elementary, Stiles Middle, Rouse High. Two houses on the same street can be in different districts.

If schools are driving your purchase, do not shop this community by neighborhood name. Shop it by address, and confirm before you write an offer.

2. Georgetown ISD is about to redraw its zones

The district plans to open **Jessie Daniel Ames Elementary**, its twelfth elementary, and **Middle School No. 5** in 2027 — with attendance zones for those campuses to be set during the 2026-27 school year.¹

In practical terms: current feeder patterns in the north and west of the district are likely to change. If you are buying specifically for a named campus, understand that the assignment you are buying may not be the assignment your child graduates from. That is the cost of a fast-growing district, and it is not a reason to avoid Georgetown — just a reason not to overpay for a zone.

The only source that settles it

Georgetown ISD runs an official address-based attendance zone locator. Use it, not marketing copy, not a listing sheet, and not a school-rating app: [georgetownisd.org — Attendance Zones](https://www.georgetownisd.org/parents/attendance-zones). For Liberty Hill, Leander, Round Rock and Jarrell addresses, use that district's own locator.

Then ask the district to confirm in writing for the specific address. Districts do this routinely, and it takes a day.

1. Georgetown ISD, Attendance Zones — including the 2027 campus openings and the 2026-27 rezoning process, <https://www.georgetownisd.org/parents/attendance-zones>

How long the drive really takes

PART FOUR • COMMUTE

Georgetown is the most distant of the major Austin suburbs. That is the trade for the price and the pace, and it is the single thing most likely to make someone regret the move.

Destination	Off-peak	Rush hour	Route
Downtown Austin	40-55 min	55-80 min or worse	I-35 south
North Austin	25-35 min	longer	I-35 south
The Domain	not verified	reports vary widely	I-35 or MoPac
Dell — Round Rock	15-22 min	against traffic in the morning	I-35 north side
Samsung — Taylor	25-30 min	not verified	SH-130 or US-79
Austin-Bergstrom airport	34-48 min	allow extra 6-9am	I-35 south

Compiled from published commute guides^{1,2} plus employer relocation resources³ and airport transfer times.⁴ Austin's peak windows run roughly 7:00-9:30am and 4:00-7:00pm.

Do not take anyone's word for this, including mine

Published ranges are averages across a metro with active construction. Before you commit, drive the actual route from the actual neighborhood at the actual hour you would be driving it — once on a Tuesday morning, once on a Thursday evening. Two drives will tell you more than any table.

One honest observation: the Georgetown commute that works is northbound or lateral — Round Rock, Taylor, the north tech corridor. The commute that wears people down is downtown Austin every day. If that is your job, look hard at this before you buy, and be honest with yourself about doing it 5 days a week for years.

1. Suburb-by-suburb drive times, Austin Real Estate Homes Blog commute guide, <https://www.austinrealestatehomesblog.com/living-in-austin/austin-traffic-commute-guide/>

2. Austin rush-hour windows and Georgetown peak times, Spyglass Realty, <https://www.spyglassrealty.com/blog/driving-austin>

3. Georgetown-to-Dell drive times, <https://austintxhomes.co/dell-austin-relocation>; Samsung Taylor, <https://newhomesaustin.co/new-homes-near/samsung-taylor>

4. Airport drive time, <https://texasshuttle.com/georgetown-to-austin>

Neighborhood snapshots

PART FIVE • WHERE PEOPLE ACTUALLY LAND

Neighborhood	Recent price	Schools	District tax	Character
Sun City Texas	\$382K median sale; new builds roughly \$340K-\$800K	n/a — age 55+	None	Del Webb's flagship 55+ community on about 5,300 acres. Three golf courses, four fitness centers, eight pools, 40+ miles of trails, 100+ clubs. About 5 miles northwest of I-35
Wolf Ranch	\$510K-\$610K depending on source and window	Georgetown ISD — Wolf Ranch El, Tippit, East View	MUD 0.5775 or 0.6500	1,120-acre Hillwood master plan at I-35 and SH-29 on the San Gabriel River. About 2,600 homes at build-out. Half a mile from I-35, 5 minutes to the square
Berry Creek	\$544K-\$574K median sale	Georgetown ISD (original); Highlands is Jarrell ISD	None in original sections	Established golf-course community around a private country club. Mature trees, custom homes, built through the 1990s and 2000s. Lots from garden-home size to nearly 2 acres. About 10 minutes downtown
Teravista	\$400K-\$485K — sources disagree materially	Split Round Rock ISD and Georgetown ISD	Disputed	1,500-acre Newland community from 2001 straddling the Round Rock line. On-site golf, pools, fitness. 10 minutes to Georgetown Square, about 25 to downtown Austin, 12 to Dell
Old Town / Historic District	verify current — newest confirmed sold data is mid-2025	Georgetown ISD	None	The actual historic square and the streets around it. Victorian housing stock, walkable to restaurants and the courthouse

Prices are trailing-period figures from multiple sources and are not directly comparable to each other.¹ Where a range is shown, sources genuinely disagree — usually because one measures sold prices and another measures list prices over a different window. Do not average them.

Where sources conflict badly enough to name it

Citywide median. Redfin shows about \$419,722 sold, Zillow about \$427,174 typical value, Realtor.com about \$450,000 list. These measure different things. Pick one and stay consistent rather than blending them.

Sun City HOA dues. \$1,960 a year confirmed with the community association against about \$1,200 a year in three other sources. Landscape-maintained homes add roughly \$1,266-\$1,740 a year on top. Confirm directly with the association before budgeting.

Water Oak's assigned elementary. Three different answers across sources. Use the district locator.

1. Neighborhood price and character data compiled from Austin Real Estate Homes Blog neighborhood pages ([Sun City](#), [Wolf Ranch](#), [Berry Creek](#)), [Homes.com](#), [Redfin](#) and [Lisa Copeland Real Estate](#).

Utilities and the rest of the budget

PART SIX • WHAT ELSE ARRIVES MONTHLY

Georgetown runs its own electric utility

Most of Texas sits on the deregulated retail electric market, where you shop among providers. Inside Georgetown's service area you do not — the city is your electric provider, along with water and wastewater. That means no shopping for a better rate, and also no exposure to a retail provider's pricing games. Whether you consider that a feature depends on your temperament.

The same budget that cut taxes raised utility rates

When the city adopted its FY2026 budget and lowered the property tax rate to 35.3 cents, it also approved a **9% water increase**, a **12% wastewater increase** and a **2% electric increase** — about \$6.90 more per month for a residential water customer using 10,000 gallons and about \$6.50 more for wastewater.¹ Current rate schedules are published by the city.²

This is worth understanding as a pattern rather than a scandal. A city growing this fast has to fund infrastructure somewhere. When the property tax rate falls and utility rates rise, the headline improves and the household cost does not necessarily follow. Read both lines.

Costs people forget to budget

Item	What to expect
HOA dues	Vary enormously by community and by section within a community. Wolf Ranch published \$560 twice a year; Teravista sections range roughly \$61-\$132 a month; Sun City is disputed between about \$1,200 and \$1,960 a year. Always ask for the current figure in writing
Landscape-maintained premiums	Where offered, these add materially — Sun City's tiers run roughly \$1,266-\$1,740 a year on top of base dues
Transfer and resale fees at closing	Sun City charges a 0.25% transfer fee plus a \$250 resale certificate, and \$650 working capital on a new build. Other communities have their own
PID assessments	Remember these generally are not reduced by your homestead exemption
Insurance	Central Texas hail is a real factor in premiums. Get a quote on the specific address before you are under contract, not after

1. City of Georgetown FY2026 budget — utility rate changes alongside the property tax rate reduction, <https://www.hellogeorgetown.com/city-of-georgetown-news/georgetown-city-council-adopts-1-3-billion-fy-2026-budget-lowers-property-tax-rate-but-increases-utility-rates/>

2. City of Georgetown utility rate schedules, https://georgetowntexas.gov/utilities/customer_care/utility_rates/

Your pre-offer checklist

PART SEVEN • DO THESE BEFORE YOU WRITE AN OFFER

Nine things, in order. Every one of them is free, and each has saved somebody real money.

1. **Pull the actual tax bill for the address.** Williamson County property tax records list every taxing jurisdiction on the parcel as its own line. This single document tells you whether there is a MUD, a PID or a road district. It overrides every other source, including this guide.
2. **Add up the district lines, not just the headline rate.** Take the combined rate you find and run it against the price you are considering. Do this before you tour, not after you have an emotional favorite.
3. **Confirm the school assignment in writing.** Use the district's official address locator, then ask the district to confirm for that address. If you are in Parkside on the River, confirm which builder built the house, because that determines the district.
4. **Ask whether zones are being redrawn.** Georgetown ISD sets zones for two new 2027 campuses during the 2026-27 school year. If you are paying a premium for a specific campus, ask what the district expects.
5. **Verify the homestead exemption plan.** Confirm you can file, and know the filing deadline. Do not assume the seller's exemption transfers. This is worth roughly \$1,635 a year on a \$450,000 home.
6. **Get the HOA figure in writing, with the section.** Dues vary by section inside the same community. Ask for the current assessment, any landscape or club fees, transfer fees and the resale certificate cost.
7. **Ask for the MUD's rate history, not its current rate.** MUD rates are supposed to fall as bonds are repaid. In at least one Georgetown district the debt portion has been rising. The history tells you which pattern you are buying into.
8. **Drive your real commute twice.** Once on a Tuesday morning, once on a Thursday evening, from the actual neighborhood at the actual hour. This is the cheapest insurance in the whole process.
9. **Get an insurance quote on the specific address.** Before you are under contract. Central Texas hail moves premiums more than buyers expect.

If you do only three of these, do the first, the third and the eighth. The tax bill, the school confirmation, and the drive. Those are the three that people write to me about afterward — usually because they skipped one.

Sources, method and limits

READ THIS PART TOO

How this guide was built

Tax rates come from the Williamson County tax roll and the City of Georgetown's own budget and audited financial report. School district assignments come from the districts and from the federal education data system, not from listing sites. Commute times come from published commute guides and are labeled as ranges because that is what they are. Where a figure is our arithmetic rather than a published number, the guide says so.

Where sources conflicted, the conflict is named rather than resolved by preference. Where a figure could not be verified, the guide says **not verified** instead of estimating. There are more of those than a polished brochure would admit, and that is the honest state of the public record.

Primary sources

1. Williamson County, 2025 Tax Rates and Exemptions by Jurisdictions — <https://www.wilcotx.gov/DocumentCenter/View/17027/2025-Tax-Rates-and-Exemptions-1?bidId=>
2. Williamson County, Public Improvement Districts — <https://www.wilcotx.gov/756/Public-Improvement-Districts-PIDs>
3. Williamson County, Tax Assessor-Collector — property tax search — <https://www.wilcotx.gov/159/Tax-Assessor-Collector>
4. City of Georgetown, FY2026 adopted budget and tax rate — <https://www.hellogeorgetown.com/city-of-georgetown-news/georgetown-city-council-adopts-1-3-billion-fy-2026-budget-lowers-property-tax-rate-but-increases-utility-rates/>
5. City of Georgetown, utility rate schedules — https://georgetowntexas.gov/utilities/customer_care/utility_rates/
6. City of Georgetown, FY25 annual comprehensive financial report — <https://records.georgetowntexas.gov/WebLink/DocView.aspx?id=723431&dbid=0&repo=Georgetown>
7. Texas Comptroller, Property Tax Exemptions — <https://comptroller.texas.gov/taxes/property-tax/exemptions/>
8. Georgetown ISD, Attendance Zones and 2027 campus openings — <https://www.georgetownisd.org/parents/attendance-zones>
9. Jarrell ISD, Berry Creek Elementary — <https://www.jarrellisd.org/about-us/about-us/2023-bond/berry-creek-elementary-school>
10. Parkside on the River, Our Schools — <https://parksideontheriver.com/our-schools/>
11. National Center for Education Statistics, school detail — https://nces.ed.gov/ccd/schoolsearch/school_detail.asp?ID=482742013570
12. U.S. Census Bureau, fastest-growing cities — <https://www.census.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2022/fastest-growing-cities-population-estimates.html>
13. U.S. Census Bureau, subcounty population estimates — <https://www.census.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2023/subcounty-metro-micro-estimates.html>
14. Williamson County ESD No. 8, budget and funding — <https://www.wilcoesd8.org/budget-and-funding>
15. Taylor Morrison, Parkside on the River community information sheet — <https://www.taylormorrison.com/-/media/sites/tm/homes/texas/austin/community-information-sheets/2025/parkside-on-the-river-community-information-sheet--1225.pdf>
16. Wolf Ranch HOA, FAQs — <https://www.wolfranchhoa.org/faqs>
17. Williamson County MUD No. 12 — <https://wcmud12.org/>

Before you use any of this

LIMITS, AND HOW TO REACH ME

Limits and disclaimer

This guide is general information, not tax, legal or financial advice. Tax rates, exemption amounts, school boundaries, HOA dues and market prices all change, and several figures here are explicitly flagged as unverified or disputed. Nothing in it should be relied on for a specific property without independent verification against the county tax roll, the school district and the HOA. Arithmetic examples are illustrations using stated assumptions, not quotes or predictions. Consult a tax professional about your own situation.

Questions about a specific address?

I will pull the tax roll and confirm the school assignment for any Georgetown address, whether or not you are working with me.



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